

5.24.2021
School Committee Meeting via zoom
Notes

5:45PM: Roll: all present but Mea Mustone who will join late

Leave for Executive Session: 5:50

5.10.2021 Minutes

Motion to table: Paul Ruseau/Jenny Graham

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 6 affirmative: minutes tabled

Mea Mustone: joined at 6:01 PM

Motion to approve Payrolls/bills: Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Bills and payrolls approved.

Report of Secretary: none

Report of Committees.

5.3.2021 Curriculum Subcommittee meeting (tabled from 5.10): Paulette Van der Kloot Rachel Perry gave a Health Education presentation.

Motion to approve: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn. 7/0 minutes approved

5.5.2021 Rules, Policy and Equity Subcommittee Meeting notes (tabled from 5.10.2021)

Paul Ruseau: We reviewed Public Participation policy update, Harassment Policy and School Committee Agenda format policy.

Motion to approve minutes: Paulette Van der Kloot/Jenny Graham: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn. 7/0 minutes approved

Harassment Policy: (sexual harassment procedures policy): we didn't want to spend too much time because Biden admin will most likely revert to previous Title 9 language. Three pieces of information need to be filled in by Supt. office if amended with proper contact information for reporting structures.

Motion to approve Harassment Policy: Jenny Graham/Paulette Van der Kloot: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn. 7/0 policy approved as amended.

5.13.2021/5.18.2021: Budget Hearing minutes

Motion to approve: PR/Melanie

Roll Motion to approve: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn. 7/0 minutes approved

5.19.2021: Budget Hearing minutes

Motion To approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Kathy Kreatz

Motion to approve: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn. 7/0 minutes approved

6:19PM Community Participation:

Paulette Van der Kloot; we received a letter from Mr. Giglio regarding the Columbus School. Should we move it up the Columbus Elementary School topic?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Yes.

Paul Ruseau: Motion to send to the RPE a proposal regarding including SC emails in the minutes. It would be a problem to include the emails as written?

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Remarks from the Superintendent:

Good Evening. This is your proud superintendent, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent.

This week is our Senior Class' final week of school. To celebrate in style, the students are participating in Spirit Week - Today they dressed up as their favorite musician or TV or film star, tomorrow is Tye Dye Day, Wednesday is "Where you are going Day"- meaning wearing a college tee shirt or a tee shirt from the military or future employment, Thursday is Throwback Style Day and Friday, the Seniors last day of school is Senior Tee Shirt Day. Whether students are remote or in school, the class advisors are urging all to participate in this fun week!

As a reminder - Friday, May 28th - is graduation practice in the gym, and Tuesday, June 1st is covid testing day for all seniors who plan to take part in the graduation ceremony and the prom --- please note, even if you have received the vaccination, you must be tested in order to be able to participate in graduation and prom. What an exciting time for our Class of 2021!

Last week the Senior Awards took place in person and Last Thursday, it was so wonderful to be able to attend Scholarship Night in person, where over 115 scholarships were awarded to members of the Class of 2021. I was honored to help present, along with Mayor Lungo-Koehn and Dr. Cushing, the nearly (40) James & Thelma Connors Scholarships to our deserving

students. Each scholarship awarded was in the amount of \$3,000. The Medford Public Schools appreciates all of the alumni, businesses and community groups who, for so many years, have funded these generous scholarships which help our students pursue their dreams. I thank Stacey Schulman, Director of School Counseling & Behavioral Health and our guidance counselors: Wendy Horne, Joel Menasha, Jason Nascimento, Krista Normandin, Alana Marcellin and Victoria Small for planning this wonderful evening!

I am pleased to announce that both our Mustang Girls Cross Country Team and our Mustang Girls Volleyball Team, won the Greater Boston League Championships! Congratulations to both teams! You persevered despite the covid-19 regulations and used that to fuel your will to win!

This past week was EMS Week and the theme was: "Caring for Our Communities" Our EMS partner is Armstrong Ambulance who has long been caring for our school community. Prior to covid-19, Armstrong had provided our schools and athletic fields with AEDs, as well as, had taught our senior classes: CPR, First Aid and the proper use of Narcan. However, this year, we are so very grateful for their assistance staffing our covid testing sites and now staffing the covid vaccine sites.

I would like to commend two of our CCSR students: Cadyn Colisano & Lily Beagan, who have chosen to honor teachers in their final CCSR project for the school year. Their "Thank a Teacher Week" began today and will continue throughout the week. Their hope is that all students will take a moment to send a card or even a quick email to thank their teachers for their help and support during this difficult school year.

Additionally, CCSR is working to refresh all of the Little Free Libraries as a way to ensure that people throughout Medford are able to read anytime they want. For those interested in making a book donation, bins can be found in the front courtyard of the Columbus Elementary, the main entrance of the McGlynn Middle School and in the Andrews Middle School.

Attention all rising 5th Graders, the Band and Orchestra are looking for you! No experience is necessary and all instruments are welcome and all genres of music will be played. Students would be able to participate twice a week during school hours. Interested students who want to join our award winning music programs, please email Ms. Rello at hrello@medford.k12.ma.us

Next Monday is Memorial Day, a day that commemorates the men and women who died while in military service to our country. The purpose of Memorial Day is to memorialize those veterans who made the ultimate sacrifice for our country. I hope everyone will take a few minutes next Monday and stop to honor a veteran. It is because of them, that America is the land of the free. The Mayor and the Veterans Office will be hosting the Annual Memorial Day Service at Oak Grove Cemetery. The service begins at 10 AM.

May is Mental Health Awareness Month, and this year the message from the National Alliance for Mental Health is: "You are not Alone". At the Medford Public Schools, we wholeheartedly agree and emphasize the importance of reaching out to students and staff alike, especially

during the pandemic. Stacey Schulman and her team have worked non-stop to make sure that mental health is a district priority. The Medford Public Schools realize that it is okay to not be okay. We will continue to work together to offer support and resources to our Mustang community so that everyone can live healthy and fulfilling lives. No one should ever feel alone in their struggles.

I close my remarks tonight with fantastic news to share with you. The Cummings Foundation has awarded CCSR with a grant of \$350,000. Congratulations to Mr. Rich Trotta and Mr. Skorker who along with the Mayor's Office worked tirelessly to attain this funding which allows CCSR to continue to pursue its mission of developing responsible global leaders/citizens who will be positive contributors to society. There will be more details of this grant at our next meeting but I wanted to share the good news with you tonight!

In closing, tomorrow marks the one year anniversary of the death of George Floyd, which led to protests across the nation about racism. In the words of the late Robert F. Kennedy who spoke about it in the late 1960's, "Every time we turn our heads the other way ---when we see the law flouted, when we tolerate what we know to be wrong, when we close our eyes and ears to the corrupt because we are too busy or too frightened, when we fail to speak up and speak out, we strike a blow against freedom, decency and justice".

Thank you.

COVID UPDATE: Toni Wray:

Medford is in the green zone and below state average. Last 4648 covid tests with 2 positive pools in MPS. 2 positive cases Identified with contact tracing conducted by school nurses. DPH and DESE eased mask restrictions for recess mask wearing. MPS easing mask restrictions for k-8 students during recess on June 1. Parents who prefer mask wearing may encourage students to do so. Two more vaccination clinics are scheduled. Vaccines can be obtained at CVS and Walgreens as well as MA vaccination sites and primary care providers. Pre-registration is no longer necessary. Nurses ask that vaccination records be sent to Nurses for inclusion in health records.

Introduction of Carmen Williams: (Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent)

Following in Dr. Tom M's footsteps, Carmen Williams is joining us from HGSE. Doctoral candidate in educational leadership program conducting residency until April 2022. Medford was selected as a desirable district for this partnership. Funded by Harvard Graduate School of Education. Brings 17 years of leadership. Was an elementary school, ms asst. Principal and ms principal: only district to receive the family friendliness award from Indiana Dept. of Education - A rating. Taught at Indiana University, Indiana Tech and Harvard University.

Carmen Williams: Thank you for having me. I am very excited to get started.

Melanie McLaughlin: We are so lucky to have you. I feel fortunate that Medford has been selected. We need you and are glad you are. See you in July.

Recommendation to accept donation from the Impact Church from Pastor Enzo:

An incredible thank you to Impact Church and Pastor Enzo. This is the second time we have received a \$10K donation for school related activities at the McGlynn School. Thanks to them for their generosity. Hope to continue this partnership moving forward.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Will this be split between the McGlynn Elementary and Middle School?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: There is some flexibility as to how the funding is used? Is a shared benefit between the schools. Pastor Enzo says it is an honor to provide this blessing to this school. It is open ended and the schools can decide how to use the funding as supplemental funding.

Motion to approve: Jenny Graham/Paul Ruseau

Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn. 7/0 motion approved

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: Some of the money will be used for technology enhancements but we don't have the specifics just yet.

[Brooks Presentation](#): Shannon Demos

Insert here:

[Columbus Elementary School Presentation](#): Dr. Kathy Kay

Paulette Van der Kloot; thanks to both of the principals for the great work and creativity that has happened this year. Knocks our socks off. Thanks to all of the principals and teachers who have worked so hard this year.

Dr. Kathy Kay: There was so much that went on all year long. I am sure I have missed out on incredible things that have happened in my school this year.

7:25 PM Dave Murphy: Budget Update

Precursor to the budget hearing on June 1. Summary of previous hearings.

Proposed budget will reflect all of the COW recommendations: \$69,980,000 dollars. Doesn't reflect of influx of external funds.

Letter from Bill Giglio: Re removal of Committee member. At the beginning of the last meeting, the letter from the NAACP was read. No public participation is allowed at these meetings. This letter was from before the renaming committee was chosen. With so many issues that have been raised during this process, the Medford community ask that this process be ceased and reevaluated and added to the ballot for the November election. (Bill Giglio, Winthrop St. Medford)

Paulette Van der Kloot: If the committee needs more time, I would agree with it. I watched the meeting and saw them slugging through the process. It is hard work with difficult conversations. I certainly saw people working with good faith. My belief is that if they have asked for more time, we should accommodate their schedule.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Are you proposing a date for them to come to us?

Kathy Kreatz: I support the extension also. I watched part of the meeting last week. They are working very hard. Had some technical difficulties and they could use the extension.

Paul Ruseau: Motion to extend the extension to June 7.

Seconded by Melanie McLaughlin:

Paulette Van der Kloot: Is that enough time? We also received a letter from the staff which will be shared at the next advisory committee meeting. I heard Mr. Lister mention that he would read the letter at the next meeting. I am interested in hearing their opinion.

Jenny Graham: The resolution says they will be ready at any date after June 4. I feel like June 7 is a reasonable date.

Melanie McLaughlin : Thanks to the Committee for all their hard work and agreeing with June 7.

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Mea Mustone, Melanie McLaughlin , Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot , Mayor Lungo-Koehn: 7 affirmative: extension approved until June 7, 2021

1. Beginning in the fall of 2021, an extract of the email addresses on file in SchoolBrains, or whatever system is used for tracking parent/caregiver emails will be created twice each school year. This extract will be used to create a whitelist within our email provider to allow emails in and out for any email on that whitelist for grades K-8. Presently K-8 emails are blocked from any incoming or outgoing email not within the Medford Public Schools and this creates a problem for parents/caregivers and students. Workarounds are challenging, expensive, and disruptive, and students and families should not have to purposefully circumvent our systems to perform perfectly valid activities such as communicating with their students. *Offered by Paul Ruseau*

Paul Ruseau : White list is an exception list (technical term). All in and out communication for K-8 students is completely blocked. Parents have complained. There are workarounds but they

are not equitable. Any email system will have a white list system available to allow emails in and out.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I spoke with Molly Laden and with the team. This will present a hardship to the network. Opens us up to vulnerabilities. Once it is opened, the entire email system is exposed. It is open at the high school level so they can receive support during the college application process. Then it is a specific use calling for that opening of the system. In k-8, we would really be opening ourselves up to vulnerabilities. I am not in support of opening this up k-8 knowing that it causes additional technological issues. Allows us to ensure that emails are being used for school related purposes.

Kathy Kreatz: I reached out to Molly Laden and Peter Cushing and heard the same thing. Molly mentioned that K-8 emails are closed and can only be used within the Medford k12.ma.us domain. High School students can use it for job applications and college research etc. I agree it should be closed down for security reasons. At my work, there were technical issues going on and some emails were blacklisted. We could have been in danger of system corruption.

Paul Ruseau : I think it is clear that no one knows what black listing or white listing means. You would be shocked by the amount of porn a high schooler gets. This conversation is not going anywhere. The point of this motion is missed. Any kid whose parents give them an iphone will access anything they want. Kindergarten kids show up with iphones these days. We don't have any control over any of it. A whitelist does not open our network in any way. Allows certain emails to get through the filter. It is not a security risk.

Dr. Cushing: I appreciate and understand Mr. R's notion. Our data for a white list is only as good as what is provided by parents. We would have a difficult time maintaining that level of data cleanliness. When I first came to Medford and found out MHS students could email outside the domain, I was surprised. In no other district was this allowed. Google Policy is for no one under 13 to have a google account. I would be concerned that on a district system we have something happen. I don't believe students (k-2) had access to email accounts prior to the pandemic.

Mea Mustone: I appreciate Paul bringing it up. The parents on the line can relate: we still fill out a paper copy for all of the information. If we did all of the information online, we could export the information. A number of parents want to be on a thread with the teacher with concerns about their child. Can we talk about getting the information online. Family ID or another product could be a step forward.

Paul Ruseau : I want to acknowledge the data cleanliness problem. It is a staffing issue and far more complicated than that. There is an unprecedented need to communicate with families.

Dave Murphy: There is no question that we are in a better place digitally then we were pre pandemic. A lot of data got cleaned up during covid testing but it is an ongoing challenge. It is continuous and oftentimes families facing bigger challenges don't always get us the information. It should be simple but we are not confident that we are there yet.

Paul Ruseau : I appreciate the equity piece. If you must communicate with your child K-8 then you must get information to a student

Dave Murphy: Email is not the platform to communicate with students. There are services within a school to get in contact with a student. This is something we could work toward but limits on safety and security. We don't feel we have the capacity right now. We do not just say "too bad"

Jenny Graham: This resolution is all about family engagement. I can't communicate with my child's teacher and the child at the same time. I would like to see the committee make this a priority and send it to the Subcommittee at the start of the next school year to explore.

Melanie McLaughlin: I make a motion to refer it to the Subcommittee.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I defer to speakers.

Ms. Ann Marie Cugno, 871 Fellsway: There were two things: Child engagement/family engagement two different issues. If a family could not get in touch with a child, the parent called the school and the information always got to the child. Mr. Ruseau said something about pornography, that is something that needs to be addressed here.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Maybe that can be addressed in the subcommittee.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I support to send it to the Subcommittee. I would like to make sure the systems are in place. I have concerns about parents talking to their students throughout the school day.

Mea Mustone; The papers for the bus pass, emergency contact, family biography should be sent to a school information system. I would appreciate those systems being included.

Roll call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin , Mea Mustone, PR, Paulette Van der Kloot, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn

7/0 motion to send to the subcommittee with amendments of adding a family information system.

2. Be it resolved: that the Medford School Committee return to having our regularly scheduled meetings at Medford City Hall along with Zoom capability. Further, that the committee will discuss a protocol for determining in the future what meetings are held fully on zoom and which will be held in person. *Submitted by Kathy Kreatz and Paulette Van der Kloot*

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: I am in support of this.

Kathy Kreatz: Following the guidance of the governor and knowing we have the capability of having a hybrid model, it seems like a good idea to return to chambers now that restrictions are being lifted.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I do think it is time - my only reservation is that we just told the advisory committee to present on June 7.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: I think it is fine.

Paul Ruseau: I am excited to return to the chambers. My concern is over Subcommittees and COWs. I think it is irresponsible to pack the superintendent's conference room with people. Without any tech capabilities and concern over HVAC in that space.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent: The superintendent is now outfitted as a zoom room and has full capability to broadcast through zoom so we could hold meetings there and communicate with the community at large. We have outfitted that room.

Dr. Cushing: While I don't have the specific air exchange data in front of me, the airflow in that room is a bit loud. We also have a zoom room at the McGlynn in one of the conference rooms.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: The governor will revise his orders so he may say we have to go back by June 15.

Kathy Kreatz: We will have to work out who will cover the meetings once we go back to chambers? I don't know what details will have to be worked out. If any of the committee members have medical reasons for not wearing a mask, would that member be able to remove the mask between the plastic partitions?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: As of June 1, if you are vaccinated, you no longer need to wear a mask.

Dave Murphy: In school facilities (meetings, visitors, events), mask requirements are in place for the remainder of the school year.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I wanted to mention that in the future there is also a plus side to zoom meetings (weather related, sickness). As we go forward in the next phase, we return to chambers but also use the capability to opt to choose zoom.

Paul Ruseau: Having watched the city council meeting recently where people refused to wear masks, if we are in the conference room and a member of the public refuses to wear a mask, I would like to know what the next step will be. I am not interested in being like the city council where people wear masks under their chin. We are not going to check vaccination cards before a meeting. How do we enforce it?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: if it is June 1, we have the ability to take off our masks. We also have to make sure that the small conference rooms have the ability to be televised.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: We could just provide the zoom link to the tv station. In terms of mask usage, the front desk provides masks at the front desk. If there is a medical condition precluding the ability for a person to wear a mask, we could make a decision. We have extra hepa filters.

Jenny Graham: I was going to ask the RPE subcommittee to come up with policy on remote participation that complies with the law. I would ask them to take this on and give something back to us even in the fall of next year. Sometimes zoom might be the better option for some people (working parents more able to attend). The other thing is I don't find the City Council meetings to be very easy to watch in the current form (the way the camera angles are set). Don't want to lose the closed captioning option.

Melanie McLaughlin : I echo the sentiment that we consider any accessibility issues and also that concern about microphone cleanliness as people go to speak. We need to think about those things too. I second the idea to create a policy about this.

Nadeen Moretti: I really could not understand people when they had masks on. I don't think they were being purposeful not wearing the masks. I think they just wanted to make people easier to be heard.

Ann Marie Cugno, Fellsway: I would just ask that people use common sense. You are offering meetings that will be hybrid and on zoom. People in the city all want an in person meeting. We need to have the opportunity to come in person. It is time for people to see you. There is a motion to wait until the Rules, Policy and Equity Subcommittee to look at it.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: We will be back on June 7 and June 14.

Paul Ruseau: I am excited for June 7 but we should decide if people have to sign in for contact tracing. People who think the pandemic is a hoax won't wear a mask or sign in. It is safety theater in these situations. Costs money and time.

Motion: Jenny Graham/ seconded by Melanie

Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Vander Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 yes/0 no Motion approved 7/0

See you in the chambers on June 7. Motion passed as amended by Jenny Graham;

3. School Committee Resolution: Condolences

The Medford School Committee extends its condolences to the family of Kathleen "Ellen" Mortell, mother in law of Joanne Mortell of the MPS Business Office.

Motion to adjourn:

Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mustone absent, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Vander Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 yes/0 no 8:33 Motion to adjourn approved 7/0.